Akoizo Original Practice - 2027 Rotation Form 2 - Answer key

Division C | Astronomy | 50-minute written practice

Original Akoizo curriculum practice. This is not a historical tournament paper. Written build, CAD, lab and communication exercises supplement real practical preparation.

ANSWER KEY - Review only after submitting.

1. (2 points) Conventional H-R temperature increases toward…

Unit: Stellar properties, fusion, and the H-R diagram.
Worked-case data: A star has radius 2 Rsun and temperature 2 Tsun. Calculate L/Lsun.

A. The left

B. The right

C. The top only

D. The bottom only

Correct: A

2. (2 points) Five magnitudes fainter means flux is…

Unit: Astrophysics equations and quantitative synthesis.
Worked-case data: A source has m = 10 and M = 5, with negligible extinction. Find distance and compare its flux with the same source at 10 pc.

A. 100 times larger

B. Unchanged

C. 100 times smaller

D. 5 times smaller

Correct: C

3. (2 points) A reflection nebula is seen primarily through…

Unit: Galaxies, stellar populations, and the interstellar medium.
Worked-case data: A region is dark in visible light but bright in infrared and contains embedded young sources. Explain without declaring it empty.

A. A mandatory supernova

B. No illumination

C. Scattered light

D. Only nuclear fusion in every dust grain

Correct: C

4. (2 points) A cluster turnoff is primarily an age clue because…

Unit: Cloud collapse and mass-dependent stellar evolution.
Worked-case data: A toy main-sequence model uses L □ M^3·^5 and lifetime □ M/L. Compare a 2 Msun star with the Sun.

A. Faint stars always form last

B. Every cluster is dust-free

C. Massive stars evolve off the main sequence sooner

D. All stars have identical masses

Correct: C

5. (4 points) Convert 50 mas to arcseconds.

Unit: Observational astronomy and the electromagnetic spectrum.
Worked-case data: A star has parallax 50 mas and approximate blackbody temperature 5800 K.

answer: 0.050 arcsec. (4 points).

6. (4 points) Calculate the radius ratio in the example.

Unit: Advanced graph and image interpretation.
Worked-case data: Two stars have equal effective temperature but luminosities 1 and 100 Lsun. Compare radii.

answer: sqrt(100) = 10 at equal effective temperature. (4 points).

7. (4 points) Why can material around a black hole shine?

Unit: Supernovae, white dwarfs, neutron stars, and black holes.
Worked-case data: Use 3 km per solar mass as a rounded Schwarzschild-radius scale for a 10 Msun nonrotating black hole.

answer: Accretion outside the horizon can convert energy into radiation that escapes before crossing it. (4 points).

8. (4 points) Why not apply main-sequence mass-luminosity scaling to a giant?

Unit: Stellar properties, fusion, and the H-R diagram.
Worked-case data: A star has radius 2 Rsun and temperature 2 Tsun. Calculate L/Lsun.

answer: Its structure and energy generation differ; the approximate relation is phase-dependent. (4 points).

9. (4 points) What assumption does F = L/(4πd^2) use?

Unit: Astrophysics equations and quantitative synthesis.
Worked-case data: A source has m = 10 and M = 5, with negligible extinction. Find distance and compare its flux with the same source at 10 pc.

answer: Isotropic propagation without attenuation in the stated simple model. (4 points).

10. (4 points) What should be matched across wavelength images?

Unit: Galaxies, stellar populations, and the interstellar medium.
Worked-case data: A region is dark in visible light but bright in infrared and contains embedded young sources. Explain without declaring it empty.

answer: Scale, orientation, registration, and awareness of resolution, sensitivity, and acquisition differences. (4 points).

11. (2 points) A synthetic star has parallax 0.005 arcseconds. Use d(pc)=1/p to find distance.

answer: 200 pc (2 points).

Numerical target 200; absolute tolerance 0.4. Accepted units: , pc.

12. (2 points) A standard-candle exercise gives apparent magnitude 12, absolute magnitude 2 and negligible extinction. Use m-M=5log10(d/10 pc). Find d.

answer: 1000 pc (2 points).

Numerical target 1000; absolute tolerance 2. Accepted units: , pc.

13. (2 points) A star has twice the reference radius and the same temperature. Find its luminosity ratio using L proportional to R^2 T^4.

answer: 4 (2 points).

Numerical target 4; absolute tolerance 0.008. Accepted units: , .

14. (2 points) Use Wien's constant 2.90e-3 m K for a 5,800 K star. Find peak wavelength.

answer: 5e-7 m (2 points).

Numerical target 5e-07; absolute tolerance 1e-09. Accepted units: , m.

15. (2 points) An artificial galaxy recession speed is 140 km/s. Use H0=70 km/s/Mpc and the nearby linear Hubble law to find distance.

answer: 2 Mpc (2 points).

Numerical target 2; absolute tolerance 0.004. Accepted units: , Mpc.

16. (2 points) A normalized binary exercise has separation 2 AU and period 2 years. Use total mass in solar masses=a^3/P^2. Find total mass.

answer: 2 solar masses (2 points).

Numerical target 2; absolute tolerance 0.004. Accepted units: , solar masses.

17. (2 points) NASA identifies M82 X-2 as an ultraluminous pulsar. What does a coherent rotation-linked pulse train imply about the compact object, and why is luminosity alone insufficient?

answer: The pulsing compact object is a rotating neutron star. High X-ray luminosity by itself does not uniquely establish that a source is a black hole. (2 points).

18. (2 points) SN 2014J is a Type Ia supernova in M82. Explain why standardized Type Ia luminosities can constrain distance and why dust must be considered.

answer: Compare extinction-corrected apparent brightness with calibrated intrinsic luminosity; dust changes observed brightness and color and can bias inferred distance. (2 points).

19. (2 points) GW170817 was observed in gravitational waves and electromagnetic radiation. Explain the value of this multi-messenger evidence for a neutron-star merger.

answer: The signals independently constrain binary inspiral and luminous ejecta/afterglow, linking compact-object dynamics to an electromagnetic counterpart rather than relying on one signal alone. (2 points).

20. (2 points) Synthetic starburst-galaxy case 2: ultraviolet emission and infrared dust emission both increase. Explain why using only visible light can miss part of the recent star formation.

answer: Dust can absorb shorter-wavelength stellar radiation and reradiate energy in the infrared. Multi-wavelength measurements help constrain obscured young populations; separate other heating sources. (2 points).